

Chicago Tribune



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THURSDAY, DECEMBER 18, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Bears explore Indiana stadium sites



The Chicago Skyway Toll Bridge, a common path for Chicagoans to travel to Indiana, shown from South Ewing Avenue in South Chicago on Wednesday. **DOMINIC DI PALERMO/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Team says all options ‘back on the table’ amid concerns Illinois lawmakers won’t help fund Arlington Heights location; Pritzker calls it ‘slap in the face’

By Robert McCoppin and Dan Petrella
Chicago Tribune

The Chicago Bears are considering a move to northwest Indiana amid growing concerns that Illinois lawmakers will not approve the financial incentives needed to build a new stadium in Arlington Heights, a top team official told the Tribune.

In an exclusive interview, Bears President and CEO Kevin Warren confirmed the possibility of crossing state lines, but said the organization also would consider sites in other parts of Illinois. A letter to season ticket holders Wednesday

outlined plans to look elsewhere, too, adding more fodder to the ongoing political debate over the franchise’s future and renewing an old threat to leave the state if the team doesn’t get its needs met.

“We’re looking at opportunities that may exist in the Chicagoland area including northwest Indiana,” Warren said. “We still believe that Arlington Park is the most viable location in Cook County, but now we’re putting everything back on the table and exploring all options.”

The news comes after Indiana lawmakers earlier this year created the Northwest Indiana Professional Sports Development Commission to attract a major sports organiza-

tion such as the Bears. “Northwest Indiana is in our home marketing area,” Warren said. “From a TV, media, radio rights standpoint and our fan base, it’s an extension of Chicago. It seems like it would provide a viable opportunity.”

Word that the team would begin exploring options across state lines appeared to come as a surprise to Gov. JB Pritzker’s office.

“Suggesting the Bears would move to Indiana is a startling slap in the face to all the beloved and loyal fans who have been rallying around the team during this strong

Turn to Bears, Page 4



HOW CAN THE BEARS WRAP UP A PLAYOFF BERTH THIS WEEKEND?

With three weeks left in the regular season, the Bears haven’t clinched anything yet. But that could change with a victory against the Packers on Saturday and some help. **Chicago Sports, Page 3**

D'MARCO JACKSON'S CINDERELLA STORY CONTINUES

When the Bears linebacker learned he was NFC Defensive Player of the Week, it was a special moment. **Chicago Sports, Page 1**

Trump keeping troops on hand

300 Guard members federalized until April in spite of objections

By Jeremy Gorner
Chicago Tribune

The 300 Illinois National Guard troops under Republican President Donald Trump’s control since early October — despite Democratic Gov. JB Pritzker’s objections — will remain federalized until mid-April, even though the Guard members have carried out no significant operational missions and have spent most of their time stationed at a northern Illinois base.

A spokesperson for the Pritzker administration and U.S. Sen. Tammy Duckworth each told the Tribune that the Trump administration plans to keep the Illinois National Guard members federalized until April 15, and a Pentagon official said the troops would remain under federal control until that month. They were deployed to support the Trump administration’s immigration enforcement personnel participating in the Republican president’s deportation efforts in the Chicago area.

The revelation comes as the Oct. 4 order by Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth federalizing Guard troops to support the Department of Homeland Security’s Operation Midway Blitz has long passed the initial 60-day deadline. It also comes as a wave of additional Border

Turn to Guard, Page 5

Bovino praises police assistance in immigration enforcement as CPD denies support



People argue with Border Patrol agents in a Home Depot parking lot on Wednesday in Evanston. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Cops’ role comes under fire

By Rebecca Johnson, Caroline Kubzansky and Gregory Royal Pratt
Chicago Tribune

Border Patrol Cmdr. Gregory Bovino praised Chicago and Evanston police departments for “assistance” on Wednesday as he and federal immigration agents drove through Chicago and the suburbs, prompting elected officials and residents to criticize police for alleged cooperation.

Chicago and Evanston police denied helping federal authorities with immigration enforcement as Bovino and his agents drove around for hours, appearing to make few arrests on their second day of the enforcement surge.

As they drove into Edgewater on DuSable Lake Shore Drive, Chicago police officers had stopped a man who was trailing Bovino and a convoy of agents and livestreaming on social media. Police said they were respond-

ing to a call from a federal agent who said another vehicle was “attempting to ram them.”

At a Home Depot in Evanston afterward, Bovino told the Tribune that “luckily we’re, for the first time, receiving some assistance from both Chicago PD and Evanston Police Department.”

“I think probably they’re learning a little bit from Louisiana how an orderly safe enforcement action works, and this what we’re after, is an orderly safe enforce-

ment action,” Bovino said.

Although Bovino did not say what kind of assistance police gave them, Chicago’s self-declared “sanctuary city” status and the Illinois TRUST Act both generally prohibit state and local law enforcement agencies from assisting federal agents with immigration enforcement.

Ald. Leni Manaa-Hoppenworth, who represents the North

Turn to Police, Page 5

4 Republicans defy speaker, force vote on ACA subsidies

By Kevin Freking
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — Four centrist Republicans broke with Speaker Mike Johnson on Wednesday and signed onto a Democratic-led petition that will force a House vote

on extending for three years an enhanced pandemic-era subsidy that lowers health insurance costs for millions of Americans.

The stunning move comes after House Republican leaders pushed ahead with a health care bill that does not address the soaring

monthly premiums that millions of people will soon endure when the tax credits for those who buy insurance through the Affordable Care Act exchanges expire at year’s end.

The action sets the stage for a renewed intraparty clash over

health care in January, something Republican leaders had been working to avoid, just weeks before another government funding deadline at the end of that month.

The moderate Republicans were able to force the issue by signing a petition, led by Democratic leader

Hakeem Jeffries of New York, to vote on a bill that would extend the subsidies for three years.

Republican Reps. Brian Fitzpatrick, Robert Bresnahan and Ryan Mackenzie, all from Pennsylvania,

Turn to ACA, Page 5

Mayor’s budget options dwindle

To veto, or not to veto? That is the question facing Mayor Brandon Johnson as an alternative plan from defiant aldermen marches toward a vote. **Chicagoland, Page 4**

Mag Mile’s million-dollar draw

The remaking of North Michigan Avenue will take another step forward next year with the opening of a J.P. Morgan financial center targeting affluent customers. **Business**

Senate passes \$901B defense bill

Annual funding measure pressures defense secretary to provide lawmakers with video of strikes on alleged drug cartel boats taken out near Venezuela. **Nation & World**

TODAY’S WEATHER



High **49** Low **13**

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 12

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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